Module 5: Tesla — Student Packet

Start here — Tesla

Read before class (5–8 minutes): the three facts and three terms below. The full blog, company summary, filing, and detailed role pages are optional depth unless a specific passage is assigned.

In class: review the worked example, explain the decision in your own words, then read only your assigned role in the student packet below. Four leads make decisions; the Account Manager integrates them. The packet works without SkillSimm access.

Three essential facts

- The packet reports adoption of Tesla's connector by major automakers in certain markets.
- Automotive revenue fell 10%, while energy generation and storage revenue grew 27%.
- Energy gross margin was 29.8%, compared with 17.8% in automotive.

Three terms

- Dominant design: an approach widely adopted within a market.
- Complement: a product or service that makes another offering more useful.
- Adoption barrier: a reason a customer delays or rejects switching.

Worked example — discuss before opening the simulation

Illustrative startup: an event tool can require a new app or work through a browser already on attendees' phones. Compare the adoption barrier and the capabilities each approach gives up.

Readiness check: Is your market still choosing a design, or are you building around an established standard? Ask a teammate to explain the task back before starting.

Choose your role

Read the primer above and only your assigned role below. The detailed role pages and full company summary are optional references. Record the decision text, evidence, trade-off, and what would change your mind.

Financial Lead

Decision

Where does the next dollar of capital go?

Your four choices — pick one

- **(A) Pull back.** Revenue fell $2.86 billion and profit fell $3.30 billion — cut R&D and capex, protect the $3.79 billion, and reinvest when the market recovers.
- **(B) Follow the open gates** — energy storage and the AI/autonomy programs. Energy grew 27% at a 29.8% margin while automotive fell 10% at 17.8%; capital belongs where the architecture is still being decided.
- **(C) Fund cost reduction in automotive.** It is still $69.5 billion of revenue and 1.64 million deliveries — a point of margin there is worth more than either new business is worth in total.
- **(D) Concentrate on autonomy specifically.** R&D is already up 41% to $6.4 billion and Robotaxi is the only thing that changes what a vehicle is worth after the vehicle itself is a commodity.

Need more evidence? Detailed role reference.

Marketing Lead

Decision

The tax credit is gone, deliveries fell 8%, and margin has fallen three years running. How do you sell?

Your four choices — pick one

- **(A) Cut price again** to defend volume. 1.64 million deliveries is the number the market watches, and we can make it back on scale.
- **(B) Sell the network and the software** rather than the sticker price — paid Supercharging, insurance and services grew 19%, and they are the part a competitor's car cannot come with.
- **(C) Sell affordability head-on** with financing and lease terms rather than price cuts. The credit is gone and monthly payment, not sticker price, is what the buyer actually decides on.
- **(D) Sell the future** — market Robotaxi and FSD to make the car the cheapest way into an autonomous fleet.

Need more evidence? Detailed role reference.

Operation Lead

Decision

Every major automaker has adopted the connector. What is the network for now?

Your four choices — pick one

- **(A) Aim the build-out at Robotaxi corridors first** — the fleet needs dense, reliable charging more than any individual owner does.
- **(B) Scale it through Supercharger for Business** — let third parties buy, install and price the hardware while we keep the software, network operations, maintenance and driver support.
- **(C) Keep it open to every automaker and keep operating it ourselves** — a standard only pays if everyone uses it, and running the network is what turns other companies' cars into our revenue.
- **(D) Now that NACS has won, re-prioritise the network for Tesla owners and Robotaxi.** We gave the connector away and got nothing back for it.

Need more evidence? Detailed role reference.

Tech Lead

Decision

R&D is $6.4 billion and rose 41% in a year revenue fell. Where does the engineering go?

Your four choices — pick one

- **(A) Concentrate on autonomy.** Every vehicle delivered is already designed for it, so the fleet is the data asset — and the next architecture is being decided in software, not in sheet metal.
- **(B) Spread the budget across autonomy, cells and Optimus.** Nobody knows which architecture wins, so keep all three bets alive.
- **(C) Slow the AI spending until Robotaxi proves it can make money.** R&D rose 41% to $6.4 billion in a year when revenue fell.
- **(D) Concentrate on in-house cells and the next-generation platform.** Cost per vehicle is what keeps us in the market long enough for the software fight to matter.

Need more evidence? Detailed role reference.

Account Manager

Hear the four leads; rank Capital, The network, Demand, Engineering from 1–4 and distribute 100 priority points in blocks of 10. Defend the first priority with evidence, describe one trade-off, and name a condition that would change your ranking. There is no required ranking independent of your reasoning.

Save before leaving

Decision → evidence and source → trade-off → change after discussion → concept and venture application. Keep your own copy for the reflection.

Venture workshop

Choose your venture's first customer segment. Identify one adoption barrier, one relevant standard or complement, and a low-cost way to test adoption. **Output:** A market-entry decision and test for Final Section B.

Submission

Submit your individual reflection in the existing HuskyCT assignment at its current deadline. Use the five headings in the reflection guide; from October 20 onward, aim for 300–500 words. The workshop is project preparation, not a separate new graded submission.